

WOW!

The first true e-commerce transaction was on August 11, 1994, when an album by the musician Sting was ordered and paid for online.



Crowds flock to the first ATM

CASH MACHINE

In 1966, a Japanese bank launched its Computer Loan Machine, an automatic cash dispenser that advanced money on a credit card. Barclays Bank installed the world's first automated teller machine, or ATM, in London on June 27, 1967.

Barcode scanner

The barcode gives a number that the checkout computer uses to bring up details about the product.

BARCODE

Originally known as the Universal Product Code (UPC), the barcode revolutionized selling by allowing retailers to quickly track stock and sales. The first barcode ever scanned at a checkout was that of a 10-pack of chewing gum at the Marsh supermarket in Troy, Ohio, on June 26, 1974.

Scanning an item



BITCOIN

Operating since 2009, Bitcoin is a digital currency—it does not exist in cash form. It is not stored in, or controlled by, a financial institution such as a bank, and transactions take place directly between users.

Touchscreens allow shoppers to see what they have bought and pay for it.



SELF-SERVICE CHECKOUT

Inspired by a long wait to pay at a store in Florida, David R. Humble came up with a solution—in 1984 he launched the self-checkout machine. From the 1990s onward, they have been adopted in supermarkets around the world. In fact, using one of these machines is no quicker than human cashiers, but retailers like self-service checkouts because they are cheaper than employing staff.

This shopper is paying using her credit card, but most machines will take cash, too